

Lobster Bisque

The secret to this richly flavored lobster bisque recipe lies in the shells from the lobster tail that get pureed into the soup itself. This is one appetizer soup that will really wow your guests! Be sure to strain the soup through a fine-mesh sieve twice to get the traditional smooth, creamy texture.

By **Liz Mervosh** | Published on November 27, 2023

✓ Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 30 mins

Total Time: 1 hr

Servings: 8 servings

Nutrition Profile:

Sesame-Free Nut-Free Soy-Free High-Protein Egg-Free

Ingredients

- 2 (7-ounce) cooked lobster tails, thawed if frozen
- 6 tablespoons unsalted butter
- 2 cups chopped yellow onion
- 1 cup chopped celery
- 4 cloves garlic, crushed and peeled
- 2 bay leaves
- 2 tablespoons fresh thyme leaves
- 1/4 cup all-purpose flour
- 1/4 cup no-salt-added tomato paste
- 1/4 cup brandy
- 4 cups seafood stock *or* lobster stock (such as Bar Harbor)
- 2 cups no-salt-added chicken broth
- 1/2 cup heavy cream
- 1 1/2 tablespoons lemon juice, divided
- 2 teaspoons sherry vinegar
- 1/4 teaspoon cayenne pepper
- 1/4 teaspoon salt

Finely chopped fresh chives for garnish (optional)

Directions

Step 1

Using kitchen shears, cut along the length of each lobster tail shell. Remove the vein running through the tail. (If needed, rinse the lobster tails under cold running water. Drain and pat dry with paper towels.) Using your fingers, loosen the meat from the shells; remove and set aside. Cut or break the shells into large pieces.

Step 2

Melt butter in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add the lobster shells, onion, celery, garlic, bay leaves and thyme; cook, stirring often, until the vegetables are softened, about 10 minutes. Sprinkle flour over the vegetable mixture; cook, stirring constantly, for 2 minutes. Stir in tomato paste until the mixture is well coated. Add brandy; cook, stirring constantly, until mostly evaporated. Pour in seafood (or lobster) stock and chicken broth; bring to a boil over high heat. Reduce heat to low and simmer, stirring occasionally, until just slightly thickened and flavors have melded, about 30 minutes.

Step 3

Transfer half of the mixture to a blender. Remove the center piece of the lid (to allow steam to escape); secure the lid on the blender and place a clean towel over the opening. Process until blended, about 2 minutes. (Use caution when blending hot liquids.) Pour through a fine-mesh sieve into a large measuring cup, pressing with the rounded side of a ladle to squeeze out the liquid; discard solids. Strain the batch a second time. Repeat with the remaining soup: blend, then strain twice.

Step 4

Return both batches of strained soup to the pot. Stir in cream, 1 tablespoon lemon juice, vinegar, cayenne and salt. Divide among 8 warm bowls. Toss the reserved lobster meat with the remaining 1/2 tablespoon lemon juice. Top each serving with some of the lobster. Sprinkle with chives, if desired.

Frequently Asked Questions

Is lobster healthy?



Besides being a New England favorite, lobster is a lean source of protein and provides several vitamins and minerals—including vitamin B12, copper, zinc, selenium and iodine. It also contributes to your omega-3 intake, providing EPA and DHA. Lobster is fairly high in sodium—a 3-ounce portion of cooked lobster meat will give you about 20% of your day's worth. It's also high in cholesterol, but we know now that dietary cholesterol has minimal effects on our blood cholesterol levels. Considering the nutrients found in lobster, it can help boost brain health and support a healthy immune system and thyroid function.

Are onions good for you?



While you may not appreciate the tear-producing qualities of onions, you will most likely appreciate their health benefits. Thanks to the antioxidant quercetin, onions have been linked to reduced inflammation and a lower risk of heart disease. The quercetin in onions also has a bacteria-fighting component. Their sulfur compounds (some of which also cause watery eyes) have been shown to help regulate blood sugar.

Is this recipe gluten-free?



As is, no, this recipe is not gluten-free. But you can swap out the all-purpose flour for gluten-free all-purpose flour for an equally delicious gluten-free bisque.

Can I use raw lobster tails?



Yes, you can! We use cooked lobster tails for convenience and for a quicker cooking time, but feel free to use raw lobster tails instead. You can cook lobster tails a day ahead and reserve them for this recipe or cook them right before preparing the bisque.

Can I use dried thyme instead of fresh?



Yes, if you don't have fresh thyme on hand, you can use 2 teaspoons of dried thyme instead.

I don't have brandy, is there a substitute?



If you don't have brandy, you can use sherry or dry white wine. Some examples of dry white wines are sauvignon blanc, chardonnay and pinot grigio. If you prefer not to cook with alcohol, substitute it with more seafood stock or lobster stock.

What's the difference between lobster soup and lobster bisque?



Lobster bisque is a type of soup of French origin that's smooth and creamy, extracting its lobster flavor by pureeing and straining the ingredients into a rich and flavorful soup. Lobster soup, such as Lobster & Corn Chowder, is typically chunky with pieces of vegetables like potatoes and corn.

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S. and Jan Valdez

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Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 3/4 cup** 286 calories; total fat 16g; saturated fat 9g; cholesterol 87mg; sodium 403mg; total carbohydrate 14g; dietary fiber 2g; total sugars 5g; protein 19g; vitamin c 9mg; calcium 78mg; iron 2mg; potassium 550mg

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Lobster

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